

“India is on the right track for scaling open source adoption”



Saravanan P., head-technology cloud engineering, Oracle India

Oracle started operations in India several decades back and continues to dominate in the enterprise tech space globally, as well as in India. In an exclusive interaction with **Sreejani Bhattacharyya** of **Open Source For You**, **Saravanan P.**, head-technology cloud engineering, Oracle India, talks about the tech innovations Oracle is working on, as well as how it is helping the developer community and adapting to the recent changes in the open source landscape. He also talks about the 25th anniversary of Java and its impact on the open source world.



Q What does your role at Oracle entail? What are the areas you are working on?

I lead the technology cloud engineering team at Oracle India, which comprises hands-on cloud technology experts. We closely collaborate with customers as technical consultants and trusted advisors to help them make the right technology choices as part of their organisation's journey to the cloud. A key area of responsibility is to help evangelise the power of our second generation, modern cloud infrastructure and advise customers on the best practices for a successful cloud experience.

Q How is Oracle engaging with the developer community in India?

Oracle has always had a robust developer engagement programme in India. We run programmes actively throughout the year. We recently concluded a highly successful edition of Oracle Groundbreakers Yatra – this was the India edition of our worldwide global virtual developer summit. It

witnessed commendable participation from the local developers. We continue to organise regular virtual meetups, knowledge-exchange workshops and developer deep dive sessions. These help us gain feedback from the developer community and have often helped in fine-tuning our offerings.

One of our recent developer-centric innovations is the Oracle Autonomous JSON Database. Built on the Oracle Autonomous Database foundation, it helps app developers focus on what they do best – create breakthrough apps, and not get bogged down with routine database administration tasks. With this, developers can provision new databases in just a few minutes, and scale up or down – all with zero downtime, to focus more on the next big app they are building. Database patches are applied online automatically. It also comes with superior security capabilities. The key thing to note is that our Autonomous JSON Database delivers 2X more throughput, while costing 30 per cent less vis-à-vis competitive database configurations in the same category.

Q How open is Oracle to adopting open source and contributing to it?

We are fairly active and committed on the open source front. Oracle contributes both as a leader as well as a key contributor to a vast number of open source communities. We are a founding member of the Linux Foundation, the Cloud Native Computing Foundation, the Eclipse Foundation as well as the Java Community Process. Further, our employees contribute significantly to efforts spanning Java to Linux, Kubernetes to Fn, etc, as well as across various GitHub communities.

Beyond open source software, which is just one route to preserve technology choice, we are fairly aggressive on the open standards front as well. Today, Oracle is a member of more than 90 standards setting bodies, with several hundred employees engaged via leadership responsibilities, participation via administrative and policy committees, or even technical working communities. Open standards, just like open source, are a great avenue for users